

Instructor: Date:

Learner: Regional Branch:

Program: Center:

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Let's Start!

It was a bad dream - that's the only explanation!



Learning Outcome

Describe complicated or unusual events in the past through a wider range of B1 language in both work and social contexts.

Ask your partner:

- Have you ever had a dream that you thought was real?
- How do you feel when you wake up from a bad dream?

Can Do Statements

- I can talk about coincidences, strange events, sickness and health problems.
- I can talk about life experiences.
- I can talk about what was happening when something else happened.





Let's Explore!

María's story continues. Who do you think the old man **really*** was?

* "Really" here means truly.



Instructions: Read the text aloud.

Maria woke up to the false calm of the green hospital walls. Her parents were smiling down at her.

"Maria, honey," her mother said softly, "good morning, dear. Your father and I brought you some nice little gifts. Does your leg hurt badly?"

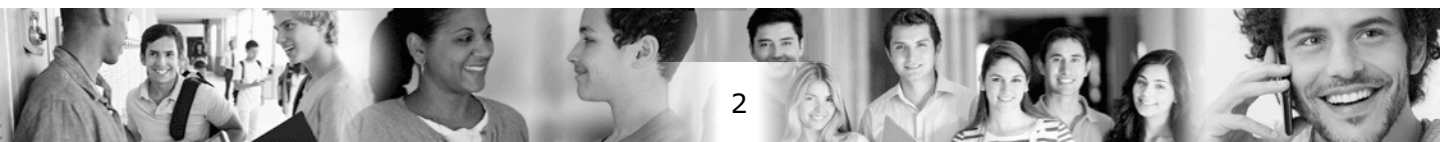
Maria was so happy to see her mother. She looked down at her body and saw that it was her own. She felt her face ... Yes, it was her own face. All the stuff in her room was exactly as she had left it before the surgery. She had had a bad dream - that was the only explanation!

"Oh, Mother! Yes, my leg hurts ... It's so wonderful! I had this awful dream that I ... Well, it doesn't matter, I'm just glad to see you," Maria said, as she was given a big kiss. Her father was also coming over to give her a hug when he almost slipped on something on the floor. "A broken glass! This should be cleaned up immediately. I could have slipped and hurt myself! Here, I'll give you a hug and find someone to clean this up."

Maria's father gave her a quick hug and started for the door. Just as he was leaving, he bumped into the old man with the mop who had appeared at the door.

"Here's a custodian!" Maria's father said. "Could you clean up that broken glass on the floor over there?" he asked the old man. "It's really very dangerous." He had looked over at Maria.

"Of course," the old man said in his soft hoarse voice. Then, he winked. "Glad to see you're feeling better," he said knowingly.





Let's Practice!

How long does it take you to *catch on?

*To "catch on" means to understand.

Instructions: Read the sentence. Mark the correct answer.

Then, he winked. "Glad to see you're feeling better," he said knowingly.

1. The word knowingly in this sentence means the man ...

- ___ ignored the person's health problems.
- ___ secretly knew about the person's health problems.
- ___ was sad about the person's health problems.

2. Which sentence is related to feeling pain?

- ___ Oh, mother! Yes, my leg hurts ...
- ___ She had had a bad dream.
- ___ Glad to see you're feeling better!



Let's Practice!

It was all a dream!

Instructions: Write the correct form of the verbs in brackets. Use capital letters where necessary.

1. Maria _____ (have) a bad dream when she _____ (wake up).
2. When she _____ (wake up), her parents _____ (look) at her.
3. Her father _____ over to give her a hug when he almost _____ on something.
4. Just as he _____, he _____ the old man.
5. The old man _____ Maria and _____ she _____ better.





Extension Activity

Talk and write about a strange dream.

Instructions: Complete the following steps. Fill in the Self-Assessment.

- In a group, tell each other about a strange dream you have had. (Pay attention to verb tenses.)
- Write a timeline of the events down.
- Write the dream down using the timeline and including Simple Past and Past Perfect and Past Continuous.
- Read your story to your group and listen to their stories.

Self-Assessment

Yes **No**

I talk about a dream in the past.

☐ ☐

I write a timeline of events in the dream.

☐ ☐

I use Simple Past, Past Perfect and Past Continuous to write my story.

☐ ☐

I read the story aloud and listen to other people's stories.

☐ ☐


Target Words

- **false calm** (expression): a temporary calm a person feels that doesn't reveal their actual usual nature
e.g. Maria woke up to the false calm of the green hospital walls.
- **to slip** (verb): to lose balance or fall because of accidentally sliding
e.g. He almost slipped on something on the floor.
- **custodian** (noun): a person in charge of maintaining a property
e.g. The custodian here could clean up that broken glass on the floor.
- **hoarse** (adjective): having a rough and unclear voice
e.g. "Of course", the old man said in his soft hoarse voice.
- **to wink** (verb): to quickly close and open an eye to communicate something secretly
e.g. The man winked and said: "Glad to see you're feeling better."
- **knowingly** (adverb): in a way that shows knowledge of private or secret information
e.g. "I know you want to call my friend!", she said knowingly.





Learning Points

The Past Perfect, Simple Past and Past Continuous Tenses

You use the **Past Perfect** tense to identify and talk about an 'earlier past'.

You use the **Past Continuous** tense to talk about an action that was happening at a time before now.

You use the **Simple Past** to talk about a finished action that happened at a specific time in the past.

When you are talking about a past event, you can refer to something that happened at an earlier time to that past event by using the **Past Perfect** tense.

The structure of the **Past Perfect** is:

Subject + had + past participle

*When I arrived at the party, Vanessa **had already gone** home.*

Which event happened first? Vanessa went home.

Which event happened later? I arrived at the party.

You use the **Past Perfect** tense (not **Simple Past**) when you want to talk about how long something had continued **up to a past moment**.

You can use the **Past Continuous** to:

- describe the background in a story written in the past tense

For example:

*The children **were laughing** and the birds **were singing** in the park. A woman **was looking** for her phone, which she had dropped somewhere ...*

- to describe an action that was interrupted by another event or action in the **Simple Past**

For example:

*I **was reading** the news the other day **when I came across** an article that talked about a trial by judge.*

The form of the **Past Continuous** is:

Subject + was/were + verb-ing





Learning Points

Examples:

- *Maria woke up to the false calm of the green hospital walls.*
- *Her parents were smiling down at her.*
- *Your father and I brought you some nice little gifts.*
- *All the stuff in her room was exactly as she had left it before the surgery.*
- *She had had a bad dream - that was the only explanation!*
- *Her father was also coming over to give her a hug when he almost slipped on something on the floor.*

